Alex Morgan

Senior Backend Engineer

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Summary

Backend engineer with 8 years of experience designing distributed services and data pipelines. Focused on reliability, observability, and cost efficiency in cloud-native systems. Comfortable owning a service end to end, from schema design to on-call.

Skills

- **Languages:** Python, Go, SQL, TypeScript
- **Infrastructure:** Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, AWS (EKS, S3, Lambda, RDS)
- **Data:** PostgreSQL, Redis, Kafka, Snowflake, dbt

Experience

Northwind Data - Senior Backend Engineer
Mar 2021 - Present | Austin, TX

- Led the migration of the ingestion platform from a monolith to event-driven services on Kafka, cutting p95 ingestion latency by 42%.
- Designed a multi-tenant authorization layer used by 60+ enterprise customers; reduced permission-related incidents to zero over four quarters.
- Owned cost efficiency for the data platform, reducing annual AWS spend by $310K through right-sizing and spot instance adoption.

Bluepeak Systems - Backend Engineer
Jul 2018 - Feb 2021 | Chicago, IL

- Built the public REST API used by internal analytics teams, serving 1.2B requests per month.
- Introduced contract tests and canary deploys, dropping deployment rollbacks from monthly to once per quarter.

Education

B.S. in Computer Science - University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, 2018

Certifications

AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate (2022)